

Others stupidly demanded raw materials, as if they could be demanded into existence. And all of the influential Nazis to whom he talked solved the dilemma by a fanatically stupid demand for "nationalization of industries," "colonies" and "lebensraum." Stupid, because even if war were needed to gain raw materials, they could not wage war without first expanding the raw-material economy ~~not~~ tremendously. ^{TP} Nor could a peacetime economy be expanded, during the next few years while synthetics gained their foothold, unless Germany exported. Ilgner maintained that he did not want war (and probably he didn't think about it, ^{that} at this time, anyway). To him, the dilemma was as simple as a problem in an arithmetic book. But most of the Nazis saw only "internationalism" in exporting: Germany for the Germans; Why should Germany give up anything to any other country?

This viewpoint, had it prevailed, ^{as admitted,} would have prevented a holocaust while bankrupting Germany. Meantime ^{Carl} Krauch found it easier to persuade the Ministry of Economics that exporting was essential to a high living-standard. But Ilgner had his troubles with Dr. Goebbels. It was still in 1933 when Ilgner went to Sweden, his ancestral country, to preach the gospel that "Germany must buy from those she sells to." While he was well-treated personally, the Swedish industrialists pointed out that Germany could hardly expect to sell to the Jews whose products all over the world had just been boycotted by Hitler, nor to those who had been influenced by the boycott not to buy German goods. There were other indications, said the Swedish industrialists, that trade with Germany under the ¹Nazis might fall off.